



WEB MASTERS

Free 60 Item SEO Checklist

<https://www.OttawaWebMasters.ca>

1. On-Page SEO

Title Tags: Ensure each page has a unique, keyword-rich title tag (50–60 characters). Optimize for search engines and CTRs.

Meta Descriptions: Write compelling, keyword-focused meta descriptions (155–160 characters). Test for CTR improvements.

Header Tags (H1, H2, H3): Optimize H1 for primary keywords. Use H2 and H3 for content structure. Utilize H4–H6 for additional keywords.

URL Structure: Keep URLs short, descriptive, and keyword-rich. Maintain consistent URL hierarchies.

Alt Text for Images: Write descriptive, keyword-focused alt text for images. Use appropriate file names.

Internal Linking: Establish a comprehensive internal linking strategy with descriptive anchor texts. Regularly check for broken links.

Content-Length: Aim for comprehensive content (1,500–2,500 words). Balance length with quality and engagement.

Mobile Optimization: Implement responsive design. Optimize for mobile-first indexing and UX.

Keyword Density: Maintain natural keyword density (0.5–2%). Focus on semantic usage.

Canonical Tags: Implement canonical tags to handle duplicate content. Monitor effectiveness with Google Search Console.

2. Content Optimization

Keyword Research: Use tools like Ahrefs, SEMrush for keyword discovery. Focus on long-tail keywords.

Content Quality: Create in-depth, authoritative content. Use content briefs for structure.

Keyword Placement: Place keywords strategically in the introduction, body, conclusion, headings, and subheadings.

Content-Length: Develop pillar content with subtopics. Use content clusters to establish authority.

Readability: Target a Flesch-Kincaid score of 60–70. Use bullet points, subheadings, and short paragraphs.

Multimedia Integration: Incorporate relevant images, videos, and infographics. Optimize for SEO.

Call to Action (CTA): Place clear CTAs in key areas. Test for optimization.

Content Updates: Regularly review and update content. Use analytics to identify and improve underperforming content.

Content Sharing: Develop a content distribution strategy. Use tools for scheduled sharing.

Content Repurposing: Turn blog posts into various formats (videos, podcasts). Syndicate on platforms like Medium and LinkedIn.

3. Technical SEO

Mobile-Friendliness: Implement AMP where appropriate. Avoid intrusive interstitials.

Page Speed: Optimize images, use browser caching, minimize JavaScript. Use tools like Google Lighthouse.

XML Sitemap: Keep updated automatically. Monitor through Google Search Console.

Robots.txt: Properly disallow sensitive directories. Use for crawl budget optimization.

SSL Certificate: Regularly check and renew SSL certificates. Monitor security issues.

Schema Markup: Implement rich snippets for articles, products, etc. Validate with Google's Structured Data Testing Tool.

Broken Links: Regularly audit and fix broken links. Implement 301 redirects for broken external links.

404 Pages: Design a custom 404 page with search functionality. Track and fix 404 errors.

Breadcrumb Navigation: Ensure correct implementation. Optimize for UX and SEO.

Lazy Loading: Implement lazy loading for images and videos. Use Intersection Observer API.

4. Off-Page SEO

Backlinks: Acquire backlinks from high DA sites. Conduct regular audits.

Social Media Integration: Use Open Graph tags. Monitor brand mentions with social listening tools.

Local SEO: Optimize Google My Business. Build local citations and maintain NAP consistency.

Online Reviews: Encourage and manage reviews. Respond professionally and timely.

Guest Blogging: Seek high-authority guest blogging opportunities. Ensure content aligns with host site.

Influencer Outreach: Build relationships with industry influencers. Track effectiveness.

Social Bookmarking: Use social bookmarking sites for exposure. Engage on platforms like Reddit and Quora.

Content Syndication: Syndicate content on authority platforms. Track results and adjust strategies.

Brand Mentions: Monitor using tools like Brand24. Convert unlinked mentions into backlinks.

Forum Participation: Engage in niche forums to build authority and backlinks. Provide value in discussions.

5. Analytics & Monitoring

Google Analytics: Set up custom dashboards. Implement event tracking for insights.

Google Search Console: Check crawl errors and mobile usability. Monitor search queries and optimize keywords.

Regular Audits: Conduct quarterly technical SEO audits. Use tools like DeepCrawl.

Keyword Tracking: Track keywords rank with Ahrefs or SEMrush. Monitor trends and adjust strategies.

Competitor Analysis: Track competitors' strategies and backlink profiles. Identify gaps and opportunities.

Backlink Monitoring: Track backlinks with tools like Ahrefs. Disavow toxic backlinks.

Goal Tracking: Set conversion goals in Google Analytics. Use data to optimize funnels.

Heatmaps: Use Hotjar for understanding user behavior. Test layouts based on heatmap insights.

A/B Testing: Perform A/B tests on landing pages. Use tools like Optimizely.

Reporting: Generate monthly SEO reports. Use data to refine strategies.

6. Sitemap Management

XML Sitemap Prioritization: Assign priority levels to pages to guide search engines.

HTML Sitemap Creation: Create an HTML sitemap for user navigation.

7. Robots.txt

Use Noindex for Thin Content: Apply noindex to low-quality pages to prevent indexing.

Test Robots.txt with Google: Use Google Search Console's robots.txt Tester.

8. SSL Certificate

HSTS Implementation: Implement HTTP Strict Transport Security.

Check for Mixed Content: Regularly resolve mixed content issues.

9. Schema Markup

Local Business Schema: Implement Local Business schema for local search visibility.

FAQ Schema: Add FAQ schema to relevant pages.

10. Broken Links

Automated Broken Link Alerts: Set up alerts for broken links.

Internal Link Repair: Regularly review and repair internal broken links.

11. 404 Pages

Suggested Content on 404 Pages: Include links to relevant content on 404 pages.

404 Page A/B Testing: Test different 404-page designs.

12. Breadcrumb Navigation

Breadcrumb Schema: Implement breadcrumb schema to enhance search engine understanding.

13. Lazy Loading

Lazy Load Ads: Implement lazy loading for advertisements.

Lazy Load Embedded Content: Apply lazy loading to embedded content.

14. Off-Page SEO (Additional)

Google My Business Posts: Regularly post updates and promotions.

Build Links from Industry Directories: Submit your site to industry directories.

Podcast Guesting: Participate in relevant industry podcasts.